



Detecting an Attack with Snort is Easy

If you are interested in security, you may have already used Snort for checking your machine's security status. Snort is a free and open source intrusion detection and prevention tool, used by many safety analysts, network administrators and penetration testers across the globe. This article will tell you how to add your own rules to Snort in order to detect specific security attacks.

As many of you will agree, it would be great to have a tool that checks the entire system in all possible ways and tells us if there is a security attack taking place. The developers of Snort felt the same and have developed this great tool for us. Snort comes with a lot of rules to help check and detect attacks by default, but it may not have all the rules that may be specifically required by a particular user. So, let us see how we can add our own rules to Snort and check for attacks.

Install Snort

For installing Snort, just open a terminal and enter the following command:

```
sudo apt-get install snort
```

It will then ask you for an interface. It will give you *eth0* by default; just remove it and leave it blank, and press *Enter*. For all the other details it asks, leave them as default and press *Enter*. Snort is now installed.

Perform a basic Snort test

Enter the following command to perform a basic Snort test with the rules that are given by default:

```
snort -c /etc/snort/snort.conf -i var/log/snort/
```

You will be able to see all the rules that are applied and all the tests it has performed.

```
Reading package lists... Done
Building dependency tree
Reading state information... Done
The following packages were automatically installed and are no longer
grub-pc-bin libnumal
Use 'sudo apt autoremove' to remove them.
The following additional packages will be installed:
libauthen-sasl-perl libdaq2 libdata-dump-perl libencode-locale-perl
libfont-afm-perl libhtml-form-perl libhtml-format-perl libhtml-pars
libhtml-tagset-perl libhtml-tree-perl libhttp-cookies-perl libhttp-
libhttp-date-perl libhttp-message-perl libhttp-negotiate-perl libio
libio-socket-ssl-perl liblwp-mediatypes-perl liblwp-protocol-https-
libnet-http-perl libnet-smtp-ssl-perl libnet-ssleay-perl libtimedat
liburi-perl libwww-perl libwww-robotrules-perl oinkmaster perl-open
snort-common-libraries snort-rules-default
Suggested packages:
libdigest-hmac-perl libgssapi-perl libcrypt-ssleay-perl libauthen-n
The following NEW packages will be installed:
libauthen-sasl-perl libdaq2 libdata-dump-perl libencode-locale-perl
libfont-afm-perl libhtml-form-perl libhtml-format-perl libhtml-pars
libhtml-tagset-perl libhtml-tree-perl libhttp-cookies-perl libhttp-
libhttp-date-perl libhttp-message-perl libhttp-negotiate-perl libio
libio-socket-ssl-perl liblwp-mediatypes-perl liblwp-protocol-https-
libnet-http-perl libnet-smtp-ssl-perl libnet-ssleay-perl libtimedat
liburi-perl libwww-perl libwww-robotrules-perl oinkmaster perl-open
snort-common-libraries snort-rules-default
0 upgraded, 35 newly installed, 0 to remove and 10 not upgraded.
Need to get 2899 kB of archives.
After this operation, 12.2 MB of additional disk space will be used.
Do you want to continue? [Y/n] y
```

Figure 1: Installation-1

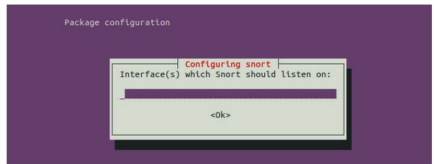


Figure 2: Installation-2

Add your own rules to Snort

Let us now move on to the real aim of this article, i.e., to create

your own Snort rules. It sounds really exciting to add your own rules to such a famous tool right? Yes, it indeed is very exciting and also very easy.